

Kris Hemans

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Professional Summary

Cloud & DevOps Engineer with 13+ years of experience modernizing cloud infrastructure, automating deployments, and strengthening security posture across AWS and Azure environments. Specialized in Infrastructure as Code (Terraform), GitOps workflows, and multi-account enterprise architectures. Proven track record of reducing deployment times, eliminating configuration drift, and scaling infrastructure to support millions of transactions.

Key Achievements

- Architected and managed cloud infrastructure across 27 AWS accounts supporting enterprise-scale SaaS workloads with 99.9%+ uptime
- Designed scalable GitLab runner infrastructure that reduced CI/CD pipeline wait times by 70% and improved deployment reliability
- Implemented comprehensive Terraform modules and automation that reduced infrastructure provisioning time from days to hours
- Led EKS adoption initiatives including cluster provisioning, workload containerization, and migration planning for legacy applications

Core Technical Skills

- Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, EKS, VPC, IAM, S3, RDS, Lambda, CloudFront, ECS, ALB, Elasticsearch), Azure (VMs, SQL, Key Vault, Azure DevOps)
- Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (0.11–1.x), Terragrunt, Ansible, CloudFormation
- CI/CD & DevOps: GitLab CI/CD, TeamCity, Octopus Deploy, Bitbucket, GitOps workflows, Blue/Green deployments
- Containers & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes (EKS), ECR, container optimization
- Security & Compliance: SAST/DAST integration, IAM least-privilege policies, Okta SSO, vulnerability remediation
- Monitoring & Observability: DataDog (APM, dashboards, alerting), CloudWatch, PagerDuty, ELK Stack
- Scripting & Automation: Python, Bash, PowerShell, PHP

Professional Experience

RE/MAX LLC | Senior Cloud Platform Engineer | August 2024 – Present

- Manage and modernize enterprise-scale AWS infrastructure across 27 accounts supporting production SaaS workloads with stringent uptime and performance requirements
- Architect and maintain Terraform-based infrastructure across all SDLC environments, significantly reducing configuration drift and improving deployment consistency
- Design and enhance GitLab CI/CD pipelines for infrastructure and application delivery, integrating SAST/DAST security controls and automated compliance checks
- Implement Okta-based authentication and authorization workflows to strengthen security posture and enable seamless SSO integration

- Drive EKS adoption by provisioning clusters, onboarding containerized workloads, and establishing operational best practices for Kubernetes environments
- Partner with security teams to conduct vulnerability assessments, implement remediation strategies, and enforce governance standards across cloud infrastructure
- Automate operational tasks using Python, Bash, and GitLab automation, reducing manual workload and improving consistency across environments

Primeritus Financial | DevOps Engineer | August 2022 – August 2024

- Modernized Terraform modules and refactored CI/CD pipelines to improve infrastructure maintainability, deployment reliability, and code reusability
- Implemented comprehensive Azure monitoring in DataDog with custom dashboards and proactive alerting, significantly improving visibility into production workloads
- Designed and deployed self-hosted ELK stack for centralized logging and observability across distributed systems
- Built and maintained CI/CD pipelines in TeamCity and Octopus Deploy, streamlining application deployment workflows

RE/MAX LLC | AWS DevOps Engineer | May 2019 – July 2022

- Led modernization of multi-account AWS environment supporting SaaS applications, implementing automation, CI/CD workflows, and infrastructure best practices
- Designed scalable, self-hosted GitLab runner infrastructure that reduced pipeline wait times by 70% and improved overall deployment reliability
- Architected Terraform infrastructure (0.11–1.2) across AWS services including EC2, ECS, ALB, S3, Lambda, CloudFront, RDS, VPC, and Elasticsearch
- Created standardized, reusable Terraform modules that accelerated provisioning and improved consistency across development teams
- Implemented DataDog APM and custom dashboards to enhance observability, enabling proactive monitoring and faster incident resolution
- Containerized legacy applications and prepared workloads for ECS migration, partnering closely with development teams
- Automated cross-account IAM permissions and developer onboarding workflows, reducing friction and improving security compliance
- Strengthened cloud security through IAM least-privilege patterns, enhanced audit logging, and systematic vulnerability remediation
- Managed Okta-based SSO for secure AWS CLI and console access across multiple accounts

DHI Group, Inc. | DevOps Systems Administrator / Engineer | April 2012 – May 2019

- Progressed from desktop support through systems administration to DevOps engineering, demonstrating strong technical growth and adaptability
- Automated AWS infrastructure provisioning using Terraform, Puppet, Bash, and PowerShell, improving deployment efficiency and consistency
- Managed VMware infrastructure, Active Directory, Exchange, SCCM, and Veeam backup systems in hybrid on-premises/cloud environments
- Implemented Linux and Windows patching processes and supported application deployments across SDLC environments

- Built internal automation tools using PowerShell, Bash, and PHP to streamline operational workflows

MDC Holdings Inc. | Technical Support Specialist | April 2008 – April 2012

- Provided enterprise help desk and desktop support for executives and staff, managing hardware, software, accounts, and network connectivity across Windows and macOS systems. Redesigned internal ticketing workflows using PHP, HTML, and MySQL to improve support efficiency.

Education & Certifications

- Certified Linux Professional (CLP) | Linux Academy / A Cloud Guru
- Continuous professional development in AWS, Azure, Terraform, Kubernetes, and DevOps methodologies